



AFTER

With Sheridan's triumph at Cedar Creek, the guns began to fall silent on one of the most significant battlegrounds of the war.

THE VALLEY REDEEMED

Having been disputed for nearly three years, the Shenandoah Valley, cleared of Confederate armies and ravaged agriculturally, **ceased to be of strategic importance**. Union military activity was largely relegated to chasing partisans and the ever-elusive Confederate guerilla leader, John Singleton Mosby, and his men.

CAMPAIGNS MILITARY AND POLITICAL

Sheridan's victories at Winchester, Fisher's Hill, and Cedar Creek, coming on the heels of Farragut's triumph at [Mobile Bay](#) and Sherman's capture of Atlanta (see [Sherman's Advance to Atlanta](#)), **bolstered President Lincoln's chances for re-election** (see [Lincoln's future in the balance](#)).

TWILIGHT OF AN ARMY

After Cedar Creek, Early's demoralized divisions regrouped and lingered through the winter of 1864–65 near Staunton, at the headwaters of the Shenandoah River. On March 2, 1865, at the Battle of Waynesboro, **Sheridan defeated "Old Jube" for the last time**, capturing 1,600 men and 11 guns, almost all that was left of the Confederate Army of the Valley.